

PathBinder — Tier strategy revenue model

Three-tier subscription structure with listing caps · Y1 + Y2 monthly projections · subscription revenue + 5% commission revenue + operational costs + net profit

TIER DEFINITIONS

Tier	Monthly	Yearly	Listings cap	Includes	Assumed GMV/seller/mo
Free	Free	—	0	Free buyer + 200-card binder, manual price entry, basic catalog, marketplace browse + purchase	— (buyer)
Collector	\$5	\$60	0	Unlimited cards, live price tracking, daily refresh, portfolio chart, Biggest Movers, full collection tracking + marketplace purchase	— (buyer)
Enthusiast	\$20	\$200 (17% off)	40	Marketplace listing access (40 concurrent), all dashboard tools, price movers, trade analyzer, collection tracking	\$800
Vendor	\$75	\$720 (20% off)	150	Everything in Enthusiast, plus 150 concurrent listings, non-TCG product listing (Funko/Manga/Posters/etc.), product scanner access	\$3,000
Shop	\$200	\$1,800 (25% off)	Unlimited	Everything in Vendor, plus unlimited listings, premium support, featured placement, early-access to new features	\$15,000

GMV assumptions: **Enthusiast \$800/mo/seller** reflects a 40-listing cap with the typical vendor self-curating toward higher-AOV cards. **Vendor \$3,000/mo/seller** reflects 150 listings, more diverse inventory, plus the non-TCG product side. **Shop \$15,000/mo/seller** reflects high-volume dealers with unlimited inventory. These are conservative-mid estimates; actual realised GMV will vary widely vendor-to-vendor.

OPERATIONAL COSTS — WHAT WE PAY

Scale	Trigger	Infra / month	Infra / year
Low scale	< \$1M annual GMV	\$116	\$1,392
Mid scale	\$1M – \$15M annual GMV	\$701	\$8,412
High scale	> \$15M annual GMV	\$2,401	\$28,812

Stack includes Supabase, Vercel, email/notifications, monitoring, support tooling, image bandwidth, misc dev SaaS. Per prior model. Plus ~0.2% × GMV × \$15 chargeback fees. Excludes contractor/agency cost; assumes you operate solo.

Year 1 — month-by-month

YEAR 1 · ACTIVE SUBSCRIBERS PER TIER

Month	Free	Collector	Enthusiast	Vendor	Shop	Total
M1	50	3	5	1	0	59
M2	220	12	12	2	1	247
M3	600	35	22	4	1	662
M4	1,200	70	35	7	2	1,314
M5	2,000	115	50	11	3	2,179
M6	3,000	175	70	16	5	3,266
M7	4,200	245	90	22	7	4,564
M8	5,500	320	110	28	9	5,967
M9	6,800	400	130	35	12	7,377
M10	8,200	490	150	42	15	8,897
M11	9,700	590	170	50	18	10,528
M12	11,500	700	190	58	22	12,470

YEAR 1 · MONTHLY P&L;

Month	GMV	Sub revenue	5% commission	Gross revenue	Infra + CB	Net profit
M1	\$7,000	\$190	\$350	\$540	\$706	\$-166
M2	\$30,600	\$650	\$1,530	\$2,180	\$723	\$1,457
M3	\$44,600	\$1,115	\$2,230	\$3,345	\$733	\$2,612
M4	\$79,000	\$1,975	\$3,950	\$5,925	\$757	\$5,168
M5	\$118,000	\$3,000	\$5,900	\$8,900	\$785	\$8,115
M6	\$179,000	\$4,475	\$8,950	\$13,425	\$829	\$12,596
M7	\$243,000	\$6,075	\$12,150	\$18,225	\$875	\$17,350
M8	\$307,000	\$7,700	\$15,350	\$23,050	\$920	\$22,130
M9	\$389,000	\$9,625	\$19,450	\$29,075	\$979	\$28,096
M10	\$471,000	\$11,600	\$23,550	\$35,150	\$1,037	\$34,113
M11	\$556,000	\$13,700	\$27,800	\$41,500	\$1,098	\$40,402
M12	\$656,000	\$16,050	\$32,800	\$48,850	\$1,170	\$47,680
YEAR	\$3,080,200	\$76,155	\$154,010	\$230,165	\$10,612	\$219,553

Year 1 totals: \$3,080,200 GMV, \$230,165 gross revenue (subscriptions 33% / commissions 67%), \$219,553 net profit · net margin 7.1% of GMV.

Year 2 — month-by-month

YEAR 2 · ACTIVE SUBSCRIBERS PER TIER

Month	Free	Collector	Enthusiast	Vendor	Shop	Total
M1	12,150	720	196	62	24	13,152
M2	13,878	806	220	72	28	15,004
M3	15,537	889	243	81	32	16,782
M4	17,129	969	265	90	35	18,488
M5	18,658	1,045	286	98	38	20,125
M6	20,126	1,119	307	106	42	21,700
M7	21,535	1,189	326	114	45	23,209
M8	22,887	1,257	345	122	48	24,659
M9	24,186	1,322	363	129	51	26,051
M10	25,433	1,384	380	136	54	27,387
M11	26,629	1,444	397	142	56	28,668
M12	27,778	1,501	413	149	59	29,900

YEAR 2 · MONTHLY P&L;

Month	GMV	Sub revenue	5% commission	Gross revenue	Infra + CB	Net profit
M1	\$702,800	\$16,970	\$35,140	\$52,110	\$1,203	\$50,907
M2	\$812,000	\$19,430	\$40,600	\$60,030	\$1,281	\$58,749
M3	\$917,400	\$21,780	\$45,870	\$67,650	\$1,356	\$66,294
M4	\$1,007,000	\$23,895	\$50,350	\$74,245	\$1,420	\$72,825
M5	\$1,092,800	\$25,895	\$54,640	\$80,535	\$1,482	\$79,053
M6	\$1,193,600	\$28,085	\$59,680	\$87,765	\$1,554	\$86,211
M7	\$1,277,800	\$30,015	\$63,890	\$93,905	\$1,614	\$92,291
M8	\$1,362,000	\$31,935	\$68,100	\$100,035	\$1,674	\$98,361
M9	\$1,442,400	\$33,745	\$72,120	\$105,865	\$1,731	\$104,134
M10	\$1,522,000	\$35,520	\$76,100	\$111,620	\$1,788	\$109,832
M11	\$1,583,600	\$37,010	\$79,180	\$116,190	\$1,832	\$114,358
M12	\$1,662,400	\$38,740	\$83,120	\$121,860	\$1,888	\$119,972
YEAR	\$14,575,800	\$343,020	\$728,790	\$1,071,810	\$18,823	\$1,052,987

Year 2 totals: \$14,575,800 GMV, \$1,071,810 gross revenue (subscriptions 32% / commissions 68%), \$1,052,987 net profit · net margin 7.2% of GMV.

Year 1 vs Year 2 — at a glance

Side-by-side totals plus subscription-vs-commission revenue split per year.

	Year 1	Year 2	Y2 vs Y1
Total GMV	\$3,080,200	\$14,575,800	+\$11,495,600 (+373%)
Subscription revenue	\$76,155	\$343,020	+\$266,865 (+350%)
Commission revenue (5%)	\$154,010	\$728,790	+\$574,780 (+373%)
Gross revenue	\$230,165	\$1,071,810	+\$841,645 (+366%)
Operating costs (infra + CB)	\$10,612	\$18,823	+\$8,211 (+77%)
Net profit	\$219,553	\$1,052,987	+\$833,434 (+380%)

REVENUE CONTRIBUTION BY TIER (YEAR 1)

Tier	EOY count	Yearly sub rev	Yearly GMV	Yearly commission	Total contribution
Free	11500	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0
Collector	700	\$15,775	\$0	\$0	\$15,775
Enthusiast	190	\$20,680	\$827,200	\$41,360	\$62,040
Vendor	58	\$20,700	\$828,000	\$41,400	\$62,100
Shop	22	\$19,000	\$1,425,000	\$71,250	\$90,250
TOTAL		\$76,155	\$3,080,200	\$154,010	\$230,165

EOY counts are **concurrent active subscribers** at the end of year 1. Yearly sub rev sums each tier's price across every month's active count, so a tier that grew from 50 → 200 contributes less than one that held 200 all year. Commission = 5% of the year's GMV contributed by that tier.

REVENUE CONTRIBUTION BY TIER (YEAR 2)

Tier	EOY count	Yearly sub rev	Yearly GMV	Yearly commission	Total contribution
Free	27778	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0
Collector	1501	\$68,225	\$0	\$0	\$68,225
Enthusiast	413	\$74,820	\$2,992,800	\$149,640	\$224,460
Vendor	149	\$97,575	\$3,903,000	\$195,150	\$292,725
Shop	59	\$102,400	\$7,680,000	\$384,000	\$486,400
TOTAL		\$343,020	\$14,575,800	\$728,790	\$1,071,810

EOY counts are **concurrent active subscribers** at the end of year 2. Yearly sub rev sums each tier's price across every month's active count, so a tier that grew from 50 → 200 contributes less than one that held 200 all year. Commission = 5% of the year's GMV contributed by that tier.

WHAT WE CHARGE vs WHAT WE PAY		
	Monthly	Yearly
Y1 exit run-rate · subscription charge	\$16,050	\$192,600
Y1 exit run-rate · commission charge	\$32,800	\$393,600
Y1 exit run-rate · gross revenue	\$48,850	\$586,200
Y1 exit run-rate · operating cost paid	\$1,170	\$14,035
Y1 exit run-rate · NET PROFIT	\$47,680	\$572,165
Y2 exit run-rate · subscription charge	\$38,740	\$464,880
Y2 exit run-rate · commission charge	\$83,120	\$997,440
Y2 exit run-rate · gross revenue	\$121,860	\$1,462,320
Y2 exit run-rate · operating cost paid	\$1,888	\$22,661
Y2 exit run-rate · NET PROFIT	\$119,972	\$1,439,659

MODEL ASSUMPTIONS

- Y1 starts from 0 active vendors. Y2 starts with 90% retention of Y1 EOY count, then adds net-new vendors at decaying-but-still-strong rate (4% monthly fade).
- GMV per seller is held constant across the year for simplicity. In reality late-Y1 vendors are still ramping their listings, so monthly revenue is conservative.
- Commission revenue assumes 5% application_fee_amount via Stripe Connect, Scenario A (seller absorbs Stripe processing — eBay model). Verify /api/marketplace-checkout.js sets on_behalf_of accordingly.
- Infrastructure cost tier auto-selects by annual GMV. Y1 lands in mid-tier; Y2 may push to high-tier depending on actual GMV.
- Chargebacks estimated at 0.2% of orders × \$15 dispute fee. AOV \$42.
- Excludes contractor / payroll cost (assumes you operate solo) and marketing spend (variable).
- Vendor tier (\$75) GMV-per-seller assumes the non-TCG product side adds meaningful inventory — Funko / Manga / Posters etc. tend to be higher-AOV than common singles.
- Subscription pricing is annualized as price × 12 (no annual discount modelled). Adding an annual-prepay discount of 10–15% would trade slightly less yearly revenue per subscriber for lower churn.